



Problem Management Policy

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+971 2 507 5000

www.massarsolutions.ae

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Document Signoff		
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1. Purpose

- 1.1 The purpose of this policy document is to define Massar Solutions' approach to Problems, related to IT Infrastructure and systems.
- 1.2 A Problem is defined as the unknown cause of one or more incidents, often identified because of multiple similar incidents.

2. Scope

- 2.1 The scope of the Problem Management Policy applies equally to all employees/resources in the Massar IT department's infrastructure, systems and includes management of the events that are not part of the standard operation of a service and cause or may cause an interruption to or a reduction in, the quality of service provided by the IT.
- 2.2 The process and procedures in Problem Management are applied to:
 - 2.2.1 Service Desk calls and emails which require the involvement of Problem Management
 - 2.2.2 First (Service Desk), Second (Engineers), and third-line support
 - 2.2.3 Escalation
 - 2.2.4 Priority
 - 2.2.5 Relationship between Incidents, Problems, and Requests for Change
- 2.3 Out of scope items for this process include:
 - 2.3.1 Request for additional service(s)
 - 2.3.2 Requests that fall under the Request Management Process or Standard Change Process.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

- 3.1 IT Manager is responsible for overall implementation, maintaining of this Policy document, and is to ensuring that the Policy is communicated to all Massar employees and adhered to.
- 3.2 Circulation of this document and subsequent updates are controlled and monitored by the IT Manager in line with the Control of Document (MAS-QH-PR-001).
- 3.3 The Problem Management processes are the responsibility of all employees/resources and/or services in the IT department, including vendors and third parties that support, manage and/or operate IT devices and services for Massar Solutions.
- 3.4 Massar uses the concept of roles to remain flexible across its process framework. These management processes include a Service Desk Analyst, or process owners and its process support staff.

3.5 Problem Ticket Requester

- 3.5.1 This is an IT resource that could request the creation of the problem ticket. This includes a Problem Analyst, Problem manager, Service desk, or any resource in the Massar IT.

3.6 Problem Analyst

- 3.6.1 The Problem Analysts, par to the IT teams, provide skills and knowledge in a particular domain, technical or operational.
- 3.6.2 The Problem Analyst will use this expertise to facilitate root cause analysis of assigned problems, and the development of workarounds and/or permanent solutions.
- 3.6.3 The main responsibility includes gathering data and resolving Problems through a permanent of workaround solution. Additionally, the Problem Analyst will facilitate the development and testing of permanent solutions.

3.7 Service Desk

- 3.7.1 The Service Desk is a single point of contact for users when there is a service disruption, for service requests, or even for some categories of change requests. The Service Desk provides a point of communication to users and a point of coordination for several IT groups and processes. The main role of the Service Desk is to identify and document all relevant incidents details, allocating categorization and prioritization codes, that might prompt a Problem creation.

4. Policy

- 4.1 Problem management shall be performed following an established Problem Management process. The process includes the activities like:
- 4.1.1 Proactive Problem Management
 - 4.1.2 Root Cause Analysis
 - 4.1.3 Trending analysis
 - 4.1.4 Workarounds
 - 4.1.5 Interfaces (e.g., Incident, Change, Service Desk, etc.)
- 4.2 Problem Management activities addresses:
- 4.2.1 Proactive Problem Management
 - 4.2.2 Detection and Logging
 - 4.2.3 Classification
 - 4.2.4 Investigation and Diagnosis
 - 4.2.5 Error Control
 - 4.2.6 Problem Closure
 - 4.2.7 Continuous Process Improvement

5. Goal

- 5.1 The goal of problem management is to contribute to the mission of the IT department by providing the highest possible levels of IT Service availability through minimization of the impact of Incidents and Problems within the environment by:
- 5.1.1 Proactive prevention of Incidents and Problems
 - 5.1.2 Elimination of recurring Incidents
 - 5.1.3 Understanding the root cause of Incidents so that corrective action can be undertaken
- 5.2 To achieve this goal, Problem Management seeks to establish the root cause of incidents and then initiate actions to improve or correct the situation.
- 5.3 The objectives of Problem Management are to:
- 5.3.1 Identify and take ownership of problems affecting infrastructure and service.
 - 5.3.2 Take steps to reduce the impact of incidents and problems.
 - 5.3.3 Identify the root cause of problems and initiate activity aimed at establishing workarounds or permanent solutions to these identified problems.
- 5.4 The Problem Management process has both reactive and proactive aspects.
- 5.5 The reactive elements provide direct support to the day-to-day operational activities of other service management functions, such as incident management, and are concerned with initiating activity aimed at resolving problems in response to one or more incidents currently causing issues.
- 5.6 Proactive Problem Management is concerned with identifying and mitigating problems and known errors before incidents occur.

6. Problem Management Principals

- 6.1 Principles are established to ensure that the process identifies the desired outcomes or behaviors related to the adoption for the IT team.
- 6.1.1 A single problem management process that is separate from the Incident Management and Change Management processes shall be used throughout the IT team.
- 6.1.2 Clear criteria shall be established to define what constitutes a problem and how problems will be prioritized
- 6.1.3 All problems, known errors, and relevant progress and resolution information shall be recorded in a common repository that is linkable to Incident and/or Changes Management records
- 6.1.4 A known error shall be raised as soon as useful knowledge is available, even before a permanent resolution is found
- 6.1.5 Problem investigation and diagnosis shall employ standard analysis techniques & methodologies leveraging industry best practices